



MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

A Reconciling Congregation
WE SEEK, WE SERVE, WE CELEBRATE



Welcome Friends!

We welcome you to worship wherever you may be in your faith's journey. We strive to live in the way of Jesus Christ, sharing God's love on a daily basis regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. If you are new to our church community, please fill out some information about yourself in the "visitor" tab of our website. You can learn a little bit more about us, and get yourself added to our email information lists.

The readings for this service were taken from the Black MN Voices website. Almost all the artists wrote their pieces in the aftermath of the killing of George Floyd. If you want to find these readings, or read more, go to www.blackmnvoices.com.

Greeting

Lighting of Candle

Prayers

Sharing Joys and Concerns

Morning Prayer

(adapted from [Gifts of Many Cultures](#), ed. Maren C. Tirabassi & Kathy Wonson Eddy)

We pray for the world that is immeasurable, a society of billions of people and outlets full of news. We also pray for the smaller world around us: for the people who belong to us, for the members of our families, our friends and those who share our worries, and those who depend on us. We pray for the leaders of governments, and those whose words and actions will influence the situation in the world – that they may not tolerate injustice, seek refuge in violence, or make rash and ill-considered decisions about the futures of other people. We pray for all who live in the shadow of world events, for those who are seldom noticed: the hungry, the poor, the broken and the unloved. We beseech you, O God, send your Holy Spirit to help us give a new face to this earth that is dear to us. May we help create peace wherever people live. Give us the wisdom to see where we can make a difference in the ills of our world, and grant us the courage to form our conscience in the image of Christ. Let your Spirit have power over us, and put us on the path that leads to peace. *Amen.*

Silent Prayers

Anders Nelson, *organ*

In Christ there is No East or West

The United Methodist Hymnal Adapt. © 1989 The United Methodist Publishing House
Reprinted with permission under CCLI License No. 3175826. All rights reserved.

The Lord's Prayer

inclusive

Our Creator, God in heaven, hallowed be thy name.

Thy kin-dom^{*} come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven.

Give us this day our daily bread.

And forgive us our trespasses as we forgive those who trespass against us.

Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil.

For thine is the kin-dom and the power and the glory forever. *Amen.*

^{*}*Kin-dom represents a hope for God's realm where we are all in community with one another.*

Children's Message

Jenia Strom

Intersection Allies: We Make Room for All

By Chelsea Johnson, LaToya Council, and Carolyn Choi

Illustrated by Ashley Seil Smith

Published by Dottir Press

Thank you to Dottir Press and the creators for permission to share the book with you.

Please go to DottirPress.com or your favorite bookstore to order your own copy.

Congregational Hymn

led by Alex Rack, Anders Nelson, Josh Espinosa, Tim Siefkes

Wade in the Water

The Faith We Sing. Arr. © 1992 Carl Haywood

Reprinted with permission under CCLI License No. 3175826. All rights reserved.

Refrain:

Wade in the water, wade in the water, children,
wade in the water, God's a-gonna trouble the water.

Wade in the water, wade in the water, children,
wade in the water, God's a-gonna trouble the water.

See that host all dressed in white,
God's a-gonna trouble the water.
The leader looks like the Israelite,
God's a-gonna trouble the water. [Refrain]

See that band all dressed in red,
God's a-gonna trouble the water.
Looks like the band that Moses led,
God's a-gonna trouble the water. [Refrain]

Look over yonder, what do I see?
God's a-gonna trouble the water.
The Holy Ghost a-coming on me,
God's a-gonna trouble the water. [Refrain]

If you don't believe I've been redeemed,
God's a-gonna trouble the water.
Just follow me down to Jordan's stream,
God's a-gonna trouble the water. [Refrain]

Reading

Just America

Angela Shannon

Reading

Power in the Blood

Louis Alemayehu

Hymn

led by Alex Rack, Anders Nelson, Josh Espinosa, Tim Siefkes

This Little Light of Mine

The United Methodist Hymnal Adapt. © 1989 The United Methodist Publishing House
Reprinted with permission under CCLI License No. 3175826. All rights reserved.

This little light of mine, I'm goin'a let it shine,
this little light of mine, I'm goin'a let it shine;
this little light of mine, I'm goin'a let it shine,
let it shine, let it shine, let it shine. (let it shine)

Everywhere I go...

All through the night...

Sharing the Peace of Christ

Scripture

Paula Barton

Micah 6:8

Reading

I Am Not Afraid

Aimee K. Bryant

Reading

Habeenkii – The Night

Abdifatah Farah, translated from Somali to English by Abderazak Mohamed Ali

Hymn

led by Alex Rack, Anders Nelson

There Is a Balm in Gilead

The United Methodist Hymnal Adapt. and arr. © 1989 The United Methodist Publishing House
Reprinted with permission under CCLI License No. 3175826. All rights reserved.

Refrain:

There is a balm in Gilead
to make the wounded whole;
there is a balm in Gilead
to heal the sin-sick soul.

Some times I feel discouraged,
and think my work's in vain.
But then the Holy Spirit
revives my soul again.
(Refrain)

Don't ever feel discouraged,
for Jesus is your friend,
and if you look for knowledge
he'll ne'er refuse to lend.
(Refrain)

If you can't preach like Peter,
if you can't pray like Paul,
just tell the love of Jesus,
and say he died for all.
(Refrain)

Reading

All The Stars Aflame

Shannon Gibney

Reading

George Floyd and What Black Utopian Thinking Can Offer Us

Keno Evol

Hymn

led by Alex Rack, Anders Nelson, Josh Espinosa, Tim Siefkes

Over My Head

The Faith We Sing © 1997 WGRG The Iona Community (Scotland)

Reprinted with permission under CCLI License No. 3175826. All rights reserved.

Over my head, I hear music in the air
Over my head, I hear music in the air
Over my head, I hear music in the air
There must be a God somewhere.

Oh when the world is silent, I hear music in the air
Oh when the world is silent, I hear music in the air
Oh when the world is silent, I hear music in the air
There must be a God somewhere.

When I'm feeling lonely, I hear music in the air
When I'm feeling lonely, I hear music in the air
When I'm feeling lonely, I hear music in the air
There must be a God somewhere.

Now when I think on Jesus, I hear music in the air
Now when I think on Jesus, I hear music in the air
Now when I think on Jesus, I hear music in the air
There must be a God somewhere.

Reading

When the Smoke Clears

Atlese Robinson

Reading

Raise Up

Joe Davis

Offertory

Musicians: Alex Rack, Anders Nelson, Josh Espinosa, Tim Siefkes

Precious Lord, Take My Hand

©1932 Thomas Dorsey WARNER-TAMERLANE PUBLISHING CORP (BMI)

Reprinted with permission under CCS License #: 11563. All rights reserved.

Reading

Wake Up and Smell the Smoke

Valérie Déus

Closing Hymn

led by Alex Rack, Anders Nelson, Josh Espinosa, Tim Siefkes

Lift Every Voice and Sing

The United Methodist Hymnal © 1921 Edward B. Marks Music Company, renewed
Reprinted with permission under CCLI License No. 3175826. All rights reserved.

Lift every voice and sing, till earth and heaven ring,
ring with the harmonies of liberty;
let our rejoicing rise high as the listening skies,
let it resound loud as the rolling sea.
Sing a song full of the faith that the dark past has taught us;
sing a song full of the hope that the present has brought us;
facing the rising sun of our new day begun,
let us march on till victory is won.

God of our weary years, God of our silent tears,
thou who hast brought us thus far on the way;
thou who hast by thy might led us into the light,
keep us forever in the path, we pray.
Lest our feet stray from the places, our God, where we met thee;
lest our hearts drunk with the wine of the world, we forget thee;
shadowed beneath thy hand, may we forever stand,
true to our God, true to our native land.

Benediction

Worship Personnel

Rev. Becky Sechrist, *Pastor*,
Jenia Strom, *Program Director of Children, Youth, and Families*
Alex Rack, *Choir Director*, Anders Nelson, *Organist*,
Tim Siefkes and Josh Espinosa, *Contemporary Band Leaders*,
Nicholas Sabah, *Communion Steward*

Thank you to:

Our readers, Warren Bowles and Rev. Nancy Ellis
Dean Ammerman & Pete Ketcham for video production
Anders Nelson & Tim Siefkes for music production

Biographies of the Authors:

Louis Alemayehu is a writer, educator, administrator, poet, father, grandfather, performer, and activist of African and Native American heritage. He has taught classes in poetry and language arts. He also facilitates workshops on racism, culture, and community building. His writing has appeared in *The Butterfly Tree: An Anthology of Black Minnesota Writers*; *The Drum: An International Journal of Writers of Color*; and *The International Process Work Journal*. Alemayehu is a cofounder of the Native Arts Circle, the oldest Native American artists organization in the Upper Midwest. He, along with composer/musicians the late Carei Thomas and David Wright, founded the poetry/jazz ensemble Ancestor Energy, which connects music with spoken word for healing. Alemayehu has been honored for his pioneering work as a spoken-word artist and creative writer and has been the recipient of Intermedia Arts' Diverse Visions Award, the Minnesota Spoken Word Association's Urban Griot award, a Leadership in Neighborhoods grant from Saint Paul Companies, and an award for life-long commitment to social justice from the Headwaters Foundation. Inspired by his most recent trip to Ethiopia, Louis will share some of his learnings and invite us to consider how Indigeneous knowledge systems could support our collective rebirth.

Aimee Bryant is an actor/singer-songwriter/teaching artist/hater of writing bios.

Joe Davis is a nationally-touring artist, educator, and speaker based in Minneapolis, MN. His work employs poetry, music, theater, and dance to shape culture. He is the Founder and Director of multimedia production company The New Renaissance, the frontman of emerging soul funk band The Poetic Diaspora, and qualified administrator of the Intercultural Development Inventory. He has keynoted, facilitated conversation, and served as teaching artist at dozens of high schools and universities including New York, Boston, and most recently as the Artist-in-Residence at Luther Seminary where he earned a Masters in Theology of the Arts.

Valérie Déus is a poet and film programmer. Her work has been featured in *Minnesota Women's Press*, *The Brooklyn Rail*, *Midway*, *aforemention productions*, the *St. Paul Almanac*, *The BeZine*, and most recently in *A Garden of Black Joy* anthology and *Under Purple Skies: A Minneapolis Anthology*. Her chapbook, *Skull-Filled Sun*, is available on Amazon. When she's not writing, she hosts Project 35, a local low-fi radio show featuring music from all over the diaspora and poetry. She curates Film North's Cinema Lounge and is the Shorts Programmer for the Provincetown International Film Festival.

Keno Evol is a poet, educator, and scholar of insurgent possibilities based in Minneapolis, Minnesota. He serves as the Founder and Executive Director of Black Table Arts, home to the Because Black Life Conference taking place annually at universities across Minnesota. Black Table Arts is a Minnesota based art organization that asks black communities what futures they want to create and how much imagination can get us there. Named by actress and comedian Issa Rae as a long term initiative to support. He is editor of *A Garden Of Black Joy: Global Poetry From The Edges of Liberation And Living*. At his core he is a facilitator of empathy and imagination. His work hones in on the literary arts and the black radical tradition as curriculum for the future. Evol has received the Verve Grant, the Beyond the Pure fellowship, The Emerging Writers Grant, and The Spoken Word Immersion Fellowship for his work.

Abdifatah Farah "Abdi Phenomenal" is an award-winning Somali poet, playwright, and creative director whose work explores the misplaced, displaced, and replaced stories of the African Diaspora. Abdi's mixture of poetry, prose, and dramatic monologues deal with strength and vulnerability, movement, and migration.

He attended NYU, St. Cloud State University, and St. Thomas. Abdi studied Clinical Psychology with an emphasis on Art Therapy. He was featured as an artist at the White House in 2015, Bush Foundation, Bushcon, Minneapolis Arts Institute, DePaul University "SJP," Weisman Arts Museum, and Global Stories in Copenhagen, Denmark, where he led the Danish Somali Storytelling Project which is currently touring Scandinavia. His past productions include "Disarmed, but Dangerous" (2010), "Concerning Our Lives" (2012), "The Chronicles Of The Diaspora" (2015), "Siyaasada Maanta," and "The Politics Of Today" (2017). His work was published by The Advocates for Human Rights and Minnesota Historical Society. Previously, Abdi served on the board of Made Here and was appointed by the Mayor and City Council to serve on the Minneapolis Arts Commission to advocate for arts related issues in the city of Minneapolis. Abdi lives and works in Minneapolis, MN.

Shannon Gibney is a writer, educator, activist, and the author of *Dream Country* (Dutton, 2018) and *See No Color* (Carolrhoda Lab, 2015), novels which both won Minnesota Book Awards. Gibney is faculty in English at Minneapolis College, where she teaches writing. In October 2019, University of Minnesota Press released *What God is Honored Here?: Writings on Miscarriage and Infant Loss By and For Native Women and Women of Color*, which she co-edited with writer Kao Kalia Yang. She is currently at work on her new novel, *Botched* (Dutton, 2022), which takes on identity and possibility in the context of transracial adoption.

Atlese Robinson is a writer, performer, director, producer, and the founding artistic director of Ambiance Theatre Company. Hailing from Saint Paul, MN by way of Chicago, IL, Atlese grew up glued to the stories of her elders. As a result, Atlese's writing style places an emphasis on the natural flow of speech as a means to preserve the integrity of oral history. As a performer, Atlese thrives most in ensemble settings where synergetic connection is the power behind compelling theatre. Her previous credits include ensemble in *The Dutchman* (Penumbra Theatre Company), *The Garden* (Ambiance Theatre Company), co-star in *Contact* by Simone Brookes LeClaire, ensemble in *Rebirth of Rabbit's Foot* (Mixed Blood) Minneapolis, and Atlese is a 2020 Naked Stages Fellow. Atlese's previous directing credits include *Naked I: Self Defined* (20% Theatre Company), *The Spectrum of Blackness* (Ambiance Theatre Company), and *Waiting in Vain* (Ambiance Theatre Company). Atlese prides herself on serving as an usher to director at theatre companies around the Twin Cities as no job is too small for a leader. Atlese's ultimate mission with Ambiance Theatre Company is to support Black dramatic writers through script development, producing new works, and centering the need for engaging Black audiences.

Angela Shannon is the author of *Singing the Bones Together*. She has published in many anthologies including *Blues Vision: African American Writing from Minnesota*, *Hip Hop Speaks to Children: a celebration of poetry with a beat* (a New York Times Bestseller), and *Where One Voice Ends, Another Begins: 150 years of Minnesota Poetry*. Shannon is an Associate Professor of English at Bethel University.

*Lyrics and music reprinted under CCLI/OneLicense.net #A-711192.
All rights reserved.
Permission to podcast/stream the music in this service obtained from:
ONE LICENSE, License #A-711192
CCLI License No. 3175826
CCS License #: 11563
All rights reserved.*

Announcements

New in our prayers this week:

- **Deaths:** Scott Christianson (*Mary Doelz's son-in-law*)
- **Transitional Care:** Andree Papenhausen

Holding in prayer:

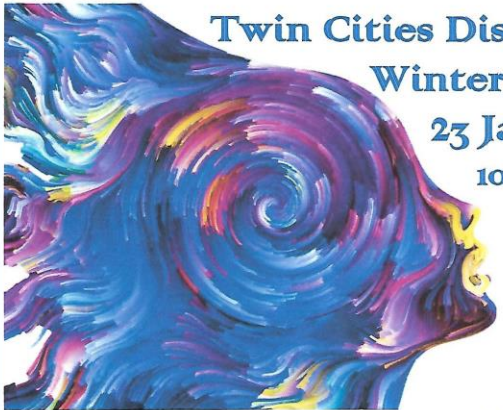
- **Covid-19:** Prayers for Valerie Mayer who is sick with Covid-19.
- **Prayers of Care:** Gary Claude (*Sue Claude's father*); Kim Neal's friend, Wanda, asks for our prayers for a 4-year old cousin, Aliyah, who has been suffering seizures and brain swelling since Dec. 27 and no one knows why.
- **Hospice:** Paul Hegstrom (with Covid-19) (*James Shelter's brother-in-law*)
- **Transitional Care:** Olive Homstad
- **Receiving treatment for cancer:** Jordyn Meskan (*niece of Elaine Chadwick*), David Miller (*father of Kevin Miller*), Carol Spearman
- **Healthcare workers:** Rene Cronquist, Deb Diko, Emma Dolphin, Andrea Ghizoni, Maggie Kappelman, Chloe Kennedy-Abdella, Quinn Kennedy-Abdella, Erinn Kennedy-Heldt, Paula Kocken, Kayla Hicks, Trevor Hicks, Peter Johnson, Sue Johnson, Dan Nelson, Fred Peterson, Amy Ralph, D.R. Schroeder
- **Educators:** Beth Anderson, Jill Carlton, Joy Collman, Jason Emrick, Hayley Forrest, Rachel Hansberry, Tori Holtz, Allison Jessee, Tanya Ketcham, Peggy Kirkpatrick, Rita Miller, Kim Moren, Matthew Palombo, Alex Rack, Eric Strom, Meredith Webb, Marisa Zimmerman
- **Partnership Families:** The Dauds and Omars

MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month (on the fourth Saturday of the month) is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. Please join us on Jan. 23 You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the trucks starting at 7, serve the food at 9:00, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend (and a mask)!

United Methodist Women

The Twin Cities District UMW invites Minnehaha members of all genders to attend their annual winter gathering on Saturday, January 23 from 10am to Noon via Zoom. Their guest speaker is Patty Wetterling. There is no fee but you must pre-register online.



Twin Cities District UMW
Winter Gathering
23 January 2021
10 am to Noon
Via Zoom

Guest Speaker: Patty Wetterling
National Child Safety Advocate, Visionary & Educator
"Believe"



Registration

- Register online: <https://bit.ly/TCGather>
- There is no fee for this Gathering

10 am - Worship

- Offering: Jacob Wetterling Resource Center & TCUMW
- Donate online: <https://bit.ly/TCUMWDonate> OR
- Mail checks to: Helen Eslinger
10280 Scarborough Road
Bloomington, MN 55437

10:40 am ~ Patty Wetterling

Noon-2 pm ~ Leadership Development Breakout Sessions

People of all genders are invited.